01 / RESEARCH

Interview Prep Scorecard

A four-page practice companion for your first SDR or BDR role in tech sales. Research the role, shape your evidence, rehearse, and choose one thing to improve.

SDR = Sales Development Representative. BDR = Business Development Representative. Titles vary, so check the actual job description.

Company + role

Interview date, time + time zone

Research checklist

Use the job post and company website. Keep a source URL or page title beside each fact. Mark assumptions as questions.

- [ ] **Product + buyer:** What do they sell, who buys it, and what problem does it solve?
- [ ] **Daily work:** Is this inbound, outbound, or both? What does the post say about outreach, qualification, and follow-up?
- [ ] **Evidence of fit:** Pick two requirements and connect each to a true example from your experience.
- [ ] **Open questions:** Check location, schedule, and stated expectations. Ask about anything the post leaves unclear.
- [ ] **Interview logistics:** Confirm format, interviewer, link or address, any exercise, and any adjustments you need.

One company fact + source

What did you find, and why does it matter to the buyer or this role?

One question to ask the interviewer

For example: What would good progress look like in the first 90 days?

> **Use it once, then repeat.** Fill pages 1-3 with keywords. Practice aloud with a partner, or listen to your own recording. Use page 4 to review what happened.

02 / YOUR EVIDENCE

Turn a real experience into a clear answer.

Choose one specific moment when you helped a customer, handled a setback, organized competing tasks, or used feedback. Paid work, volunteering, and projects can all give you useful evidence.

> **Keep it true.** Describe your own contribution. Use numbers only when you can support them. If you do not have a metric, explain an outcome you actually observed. Do not borrow someone else's story or imply you held a sales role you did not hold.

Skill from the job post I want to show

S / Situation

Where were you, and what specific problem came up? Leave out private customer details.

T / Task

What were you responsible for? What needed to happen?

A / Action

What did you personally do or say? Give the steps, not just “we worked together.”

R / Result + learning

What changed? What did you learn or change afterward?

Connection to this SDR / BDR role

Which daily task would this experience help you with, and how?

Say it, then check it

Aim for a focused first answer, then leave room for follow-up. Can you explain “What exactly did you do?” and “How do you know what changed?” If not, add a missing fact or choose a better example.

03 / REHEARSE

Five questions. Your words.

Write a few cues for each answer. Practice aloud rather than memorizing a script. These are practice prompts, not a promise of what an employer will ask.

1. Walk me through your background.

Current work or focus, one relevant experience, and why this role is your next step. Try a 60-90 second first take; adjust to the interview format.

My introduction cues

2. Why sales, and why an SDR or BDR role?

Give your real motivation. Show that you understand prospecting, outreach, rejection, and follow-up, rather than only the job title.

My reason + what I understand about the work

3. Tell me about a time you faced rejection or a setback.

Use a true example. Explain what you tried, how you responded, and what you learned. Page 2 can help.

My example + adjustment

4. How do you manage a high volume of tasks?

Describe a real system for prioritizing, tracking, and following up. Use an example from your own work, even if it was outside sales.

My system + evidence

5. Why this company?

Connect one verified company detail to a genuine reason you are interested. Be ready to name where you found it.

Company fact + personal connection

> **Run a short mock.** Answer the five prompts, take one follow-up question, then ask your closing question. Ask your partner to note exact words or moments, not whether you “seemed confident.”

04 / REVIEW + RETRY

Find your next practice move.

Score only what you observed in this mock. Leave untested rows blank. These are practice anchors, not a validated hiring assessment or a prediction of an offer. There is no passing score.

Practice date + reviewer

One exact phrase or moment to review

Six dimensions: 0 = not shown, 1 = partly shown, 2 = clearly shown

Dimension	0	1	2	Score
Clear introduction	No relevant experience or reason for the role.	Gives experience or a reason, but no clear connection.	Connects relevant experience to a clear reason for the role.	
Truthful evidence	No specific example offered.	Gives context but own action or outcome is unclear.	Gives a specific situation, own action, and supported outcome.	
Role understanding	Does not explain the daily work.	Names one relevant task.	Explains outreach, qualification, and follow-up in this role.	
Company research	Gives only a generic reason.	Names a verified company fact.	Links a verified fact to the buyer, role, or own interest.	
Listening + response	Misses the question or follow-up.	Addresses part of it; needs a prompt to refocus.	Answers the question and follow-up, clarifying when needed.	
Thoughtful close	No question or next-step check.	Asks a relevant question or checks next steps.	Asks a relevant question and checks next steps or timing.	

Review the content, not accent, eye contact, appearance, background, disability, or personal circumstances. Adapt the format and timing to the person's access needs. A pause is not a failure.

One change I will make + evidence I want to hear on the retry

Retry date + question to repeat

After retry: what changed?

Keep practicing: Outflow free resources (outflow.academy/resources).
Further reading: National Careers Service: The STAR method and Interview tips. The mock rubric is an original practice aid.